

AUGUST 2026

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For optimal on-screen rendering, please consider viewing this PDF in Microsoft Edge or SumatraPDF.
Adobe Reader applies smoothing and weight-reduction algorithms that may distort the typographic adjustments presented in this document.

“Ah! But his miserliness was not of *ledger and coin* alone! Long had it curdled into a *poverty of the spirit* and a poverty of the soul, born of a suspicion that clung to every human being who crossed his path.”

Kindly note:

These typographic projects were developed using the 2012 open-source typeface Crimson Roman by Sebastian Kosch, and were duly communicated to its author in August 2026 via X and GitHub, out of consideration for his work and for his generosity in releasing the typeface under an open-source license. Full right to object, introduce adjustments, or withdraw association is hereby granted to him, should he choose to exercise it, as will be posted on the project's GitHub page should he so require.

These drafts are not intended as any form of typographic review – as will be clarified below – but rather as a response to the challenges that poor print quality and modern PDF rendering pose to typography and document production today.

They may contain artifacts and kerning issues that only professional type designers will be able to address with the use of appropriate software.

The projects are made available on TypeDrawers, r/typography, and GitHub free of any editorial rights in order to gather any improvements, suggestions or reviews they may attract, all of which will be deeply appreciated.

Thank you in advance for any feedback you may wish to share.

The Carmesine-recast project

Introduction

In recent years, many professionals have surely started to notice a curious and troubling phenomenon with their everyday office printing, which is the noticeable degradation of their document display quality.

Traditional fonts that were once reliable now appear paler and distractingly thin, making on-screen reading unexpectedly tiring. At the same time, low-quality or mass office printing is exposing or sharpening hinting and cursive solutions that were once softened by the natural ink bleed on paper. Inconsistent rendering across different PDF readers is also subjecting carefully crafted typefaces to poor formatting, reducing weeks or months of fine typographic tuning to the visual equivalent of a fax-like output.

As an example, Times New Roman, which was once a dependable classic, is now feeling strangely lifeless, overly sharp, and distracting both on screen and in print, demanding far more effort from the reader than its original design intended.

At the same time, the unforgiving cost of printer ink – still one of the most expensive liquids in the world – and industry practices like microchipped cartridges designed to lock in consumers (a form of vendor lock-in) are prompting the choice of low-cost mass printing solutions, at the direct expense of document display and print quality.

However, printing choices are only half the battle, as the exact same PDF file can also appear overly thin and washed out in Adobe Reader, but regain weight, clarity, and balance when opened in Microsoft Edge or Sumatra PDF.

Yet, despite this discrepancy in display and print quality, the phenomenon is rarely acknowledged by professional type designers, who – with notable exceptions like Matthew Butterick (Equity), Robert Slimbach (Minion), and many others now offering A and B grades with their work – appear to design primarily for high-end displays and fine offset printing.

Therefore, the scope of this project required a different approach: to jump-start and spark interest in updating an existing

open-source typeface, such as Crimson, specifically designed—where possible—to anticipate and counter the quirks of Adobe Reader, inkjet, laser, and smart-tank systems. In other words, to build a workhorse typeface that prioritizes cross-platform consistency over a formal typographic perfection that would otherwise be lost in modern printing and display environments.

That said, this project was developed from Sebastian Kosch’s 2012 open-source Crimson Roman font, whose innate and widely recognized elegance deserves, in our view, a modern reinterpretation capable of reclaiming and protecting its place among the finest everyday serif typefaces under today’s challenging conditions.

Several outcomes were reached which, hopefully, will be enriched by further contributions from the community: Amor, “Roma”, “Romanesca”, and “Romanista”. Among these, several related refinements were included as variants B, C, and D. Should you wish to contribute, we would deeply appreciate the addition of your own reinterpretation variants to the project!

For such purposes, we suggest viewing this PDF first in Edge or Sumatra PDF, and only then in Adobe Reader, to experience firsthand how starkly different the rendering can be.

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However, this draft is not a critique or review of such a widely recognised font, but merely a set of exploratory tests on its use within legal and academic contexts.

While relying on FontForge and AI analysis (Microsoft Copilot), these samples could aspire to nothing more than to evaluate how its paragraph colour, x-height behaviour, and OTF/TTF rendering robustness would perform on screen and in print. An italic and semi-bold option will be presented at a later stage.

You, dear reader, shall always be the judge of all its outcomes—but, more importantly, the driving force, inspiration, and building hands that might lead the project to a better result.

About the name "Carmesine"

As already explained, this project is based on a recast and re-interpretation of Sebastian Kosch's 2012 Crimson Roman font. However, as it is an independent effort in no way affiliated with the author or the original release, it required a name that would avoid any ambiguity or open-license infringement regarding the font on which it is based.

With that in mind, it was realized that the word "crimson" refers to the deep red-purple color rendered in Portuguese as "carmesim" — an adaptation of the Arabic *qirmizī*, following a phonetic pattern also seen in loanwords like "jasmim" (from *yasmīn* — jasmine), "jardim" (from *jardīn* — garden), and "alecrim" (from *al-iklīl* — rosemary).

However, its "-im" ending — which is characteristic nasal sound that evolved from Latin into Galician-Portuguese — would also appear difficult to pronounce and recall for many international readers, who are more accustomed to terminations ending in "-i" or "-in" (often pronounced as "-ine" with a silent "e"), as seen across multiple languages:

– "Crimson" in English; "cramoisi" or "carmin" in French; "karmozijn", "karmozijnrood", or "karmijn" in Dutch; "Karmesin", "Karmesinrot", or "Karmasin" in German; "chermisi" or "chermisi" in Italian; "karmazyn" in Polish; "karmesin" in Croatian; "karmínová barva" or "karmínová farba" in Czech and Slovak; "багряный" (*bagryanyj*) and "малиновый" (*malinovyj*) in Russian; "karmosin" in Scandinavian languages (Swedish, Danish, and Norwegian); "karminas" in Lithuanian; "karmīns" in Latvian;

– "βαθυκόκκινο" (*vathykókkino*) or "καρμίνιο" (*karmínio*) in Greek; "Carmesim" in Portuguese and "carmensín" in Castilian Spanish.

Consequently, adopting the suffix "-sine" provided a natural bridge — a termination widely recognized across Western typographic traditions, giving rise to Carmesine: a name that offers a stable pronunciation, elegant cadence, and a phonetic character aligned with the typographic identity of the project.

Additionally, this project is entirely distinct from and has no connection to Rafael Jordán's "Carmensin" typeface, which itself appears to derive from the Castilian spelling of the aforesaid red-purple color (carmensín).

2012 Crimson Roman by Sebastian Kosch

E F P R K k y

Project Glyph refinements:

E F P R K k y

2012 Crimson Roman

Embolden: ---

Typo line gap: ---

Scale uniformly: ---

X & Y: ---

X-height: ---

Format: Open Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

In fact, as they might ultimately observe, in its essence “compliance” would not amount to anything other than the mere “act of obeying a law or rule, especially one that controls a particular industry or type of work”, as specified by the Cambridge Dictionary and further illustrated with the example: “this cake was made in strict compliance with its recipe”, from which the industry, thereafter, framed its own understanding of the term as the “specific requirements applicable to a service or product intended to be made available to the public or in a public market” or even more broadly, by extension, expanding into proactive risk mitigation and due diligence, as “all the actions meant to assure and protect the business against any unforeseen risks, legal, commercial and financial, whatever their nature.”

OPTION 1. (Amor)

Embolden by: ---

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 445

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: TrueType format tends to deliver a more stable and consistent result under poor rasterization, weak anti-aliasing, or low-quality laser printing. Even these modest adjustments significantly improve Crimson’s performance across common office-grade output systems. It is our preferred variant in terms of elegance and fidelity to Crimson’s original spirit.

OPTION 2. (Amor B)

Embolden by: ---

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 450

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: The increased x-height improves readability at smaller sizes, but the 5-pt rise introduces noticeable imbalance in display environments. While technically stronger in low-quality printing, this variant departs more visibly from Crimson’s classical proportions, making it a functional but less stylistically faithful interpretation.

OPTION 3. (Roma)

Embolden by: 1

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 445

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Roma offers the most stable and predictable behaviour across all environments. Style 1 combined with a moderate x-height increase preserves Crimson’s original elegance while improving robustness under weak anti-aliasing and poor rasterization. This balance makes Roma the safest all-purpose configuration for mixed digital-and-print workflows, retaining a clear literary texture without sacrificing technical reliability.

OPTION 4. (Roma B)

Embolden by: 1

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 450

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Roma B enhances clarity through a higher x-height, improving readability at smaller sizes and on modern displays. This adjustment strengthens performance under imperfect rasterization, though it departs slightly from Crimson’s classical proportions. Roma B is a practical, work-ready variant: visually consistent, technically resilient, and well-suited for professional documents where legibility takes priority over strict stylistic fidelity.

OPTION 5. (Roma C)

Embolden by: 1

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: 78 - 112

X-height: 445

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Roma C introduces structural reinforcement through the X:78 / Y:112 adjustments, producing a firmer optical density and greater stability across long-form text. These refinements significantly improve behaviour in PDFs, laser printing, and extended reading, while maintaining a smooth and balanced texture. Roma C stands as a technically refined, professional-grade interpretation ideal for legal, academic, and administrative contexts.

OPTION 6. (Roma D)

Embolden by: 1

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: 78 - 112

X-height: 450

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Roma D represents the most balanced and mature configuration in the series. By combining the structural reinforcement of Roma C with a higher x-height, it achieves exceptional clarity, smoothness, and cross-platform consistency. It preserves Crimson’s original voice while correcting its vulnerabilities in modern display and printing environments. Roma D is the project’s universal workhorse: elegant, robust, and reliable in every workflow.

OPTION 7. (Romanesca)

Embolden by: 2

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 445

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Romanesca introduces a more assertive texture, designed to withstand weak anti-aliasing, coarse rasterization, and low-quality office printing. The increased embolden value strengthens stroke presence without collapsing Crimson’s underlying structure, making this variant highly reliable in environments where lighter serif designs tend to wash out. Romanesca is a robust, high-contrast interpretation, ideal for mass-printing workflows and documents that require maximum stability under imperfect output conditions.

OPTION 8. (Romanesca B)

Embolden by: 2

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: ---

X-height: 450

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Romanesca B amplifies the resilience of Romanesca by combining its reinforced stroke weight with a higher x-height. This configuration produces exceptional clarity in harsh rasterization environments, though it departs more visibly from Crimson’s classical proportions and literary softness. It is the project’s most durable and print-oriented variant, prioritising legibility and output reliability over stylistic fidelity, particularly suited for high-volume office printing, legal bundles, and any workflow where consistency outweighs aesthetic nuance.

OPTION 9. (Romanista)

Embolden by: 2

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: 78 - 112

X-height: 445

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

In fact, as they might ultimately observe, in its essence “compliance” would not amount to anything other than the mere “act of obeying a law or rule, especially one that controls a particular industry or type of work”, as specified by the Cambridge Dictionary and further illustrated with the example: “this cake was made in strict compliance with its recipe”, from which the industry, thereafter, framed its own understanding of the term as the “specific requirements applicable to a service or product intended to be made available to the public or in a public market” or even more broadly, by extension, expanding into proactive risk mitigation and due diligence, as “all the actions meant to assure and protect the business against any unforeseen risks, legal, commercial and financial, whatever their nature.”

AI: Romanista balances structural reinforcement with a more refined texture than Romanesca, preserving more of Crimson’s original rhythm and elegance. The increased embolden value and adjusted X/Y parameters improve stability in PDF rendering and laser printing while maintaining a smoother, less aggressive appearance. Romanista is a technically strengthened yet stylistically moderate variant, suitable for professional documents that require clarity and firmness without sacrificing overall refinement.

OPTION 10. (Romanista B)

Embolden by: 2

Typo line gap: 270

Scale uniformly: 102%

X & Y: 78 - 112

X-height: 450

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance” were to be described in law – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand (“compliance by governance”) – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, assess, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, certainly the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would likely react with considerable surprise, if not outright scrutiny or resistance.

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AI: Romanista B combines a higher x-height with reinforced X/Y proportions, producing a firm, clear, and highly consistent texture across all major PDF viewers. It offers excellent stability under weak anti-aliasing and modern smoothing algorithms, making it a precise, cross-platform-reliable variant for digital-first and long-form professional documents.

AMOR, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading: 1,1).

AMOR B, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMA, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMA B, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMA C, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMA D, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMANESCA, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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ROMANESCA B, comparison with Times New Roman:

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described – as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand – as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance or profit-making purposes”, surely the industry and the public – particularly in common-law jurisdictions – would always react with considerable surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance. (size 12 pts, leading 1 pt)

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AI Conclusions (MS Copilot)

Carmesine font (Roma D), size 12, line spacing 1.15 adjusted in MS Word

The exploratory adjustments presented in this document illustrate how Crimson Roman responds to a wide range of typographic conditions relevant to legal and academic writing, particularly in environments affected by inconsistent PDF rendering, weak anti-aliasing, and low-quality office printing.

As the samples demonstrate, Crimson's original design retains exceptional elegance and classical balance, yet its low x-height, delicate outlines, and narrow lowercase proportions expose it to several challenges in modern digital workflows and everyday print systems.

Across all tested configurations, the variants revealed distinct behaviours rather than a single hierarchy of quality.

Amor preserves the closest connection to Crimson's original spirit, offering improved stability through TrueType export while maintaining a soft, literary texture.

Amor B increases x-height to enhance readability, though at the cost of introducing slight display imbalance and reducing stylistic fidelity.

The Roma series represents the project's most balanced group of interpretations.

Roma, using Style 1 and a moderate x-height increase, proved to be the most stable and predictable configuration across all environments, strengthening paragraph colour while remaining visually aligned with Crimson's design philosophy.

Roma B offers greater clarity through a higher x-height, producing a darker, more legible text block suited for dense legal and academic writing.

Roma C introduces structural reinforcement that improves stability in PDFs and long-form reading.

Roma D combines these refinements into the project’s most universally consistent variant, achieving exceptional clarity and cross-platform reliability.

The Style 2 variants provide progressively stronger paragraph colour and improved resilience under office-grade printing.

Romanesca delivers a denser, more assertive texture that withstands weak anti-aliasing and coarse rasterization.

Romanesca B maximizes print robustness, offering the strongest legibility under challenging production conditions.

Romanista balances reinforcement with a smoother tonal profile, retaining more of Crimson’s elegance.

Romanista B provides high-precision stability across major PDF viewers and modern smoothing algorithms, making it particularly effective in digital-first workflows.

These observations are not intended as definitive typographic solutions, but rather as practical findings from real-world experimentation conducted in FontForge with analytical support from AI.

They suggest that Crimson Roman possesses significant potential for professional legal and academic contexts if revisited with contemporary production realities in mind.

Ultimately, the variants presented here represent complementary reinterpretations of Crimson Roman, each adapted to different workflows, rendering conditions, and printing constraints.

They demonstrate that even modest adjustments — to x-height, style, scaling, line gap, and export format — can meaningfully improve performance while preserving, to varying degrees, the character of Sebastian Kosch’s original design.

AI's (and our) overall choice: Roma D (Carmesine Font)

Roma D stands out as the most balanced and typographically mature configuration in the entire Common Serif series. It achieves exceptional clarity, stability, and cross-platform consistency by combining structural reinforcement with a carefully increased x-height, all while preserving the elegance and tonal character of Crimson Roman.

Among the tested variants, it is the one that, in our judgment, delivers the strongest overall performance across digital rendering, PDF environments, and everyday office printing. For this reason, Roma D is the project's preferred all-purpose serif for professional legal and academic workflows.

Carmesine
Italica
Semi-negrita

Disclaimer to the reader

Please be advised that the closing sample set forth ahead — and the Dickensian tone it employs — is not intended to exercise any form of irreverence, but, on the contrary, and while paying due homage to the author, to summon his enduring voice in order to draw attention to a grave and growing danger of our present age: the erosion of privacy as a cornerstone of personal freedom, and with it, the erosion of reason, dignity, and the quiet space in which human life unfolds.

This short narrative is offered as a typographic specimen, allowing the reader to observe the behaviour of the Common Serif font across different PDF viewers, screens, and printing environments. It is not intended as a full literary work, but as a practical demonstration of paragraph colour, rhythm, and long-form readability.

The privileges afforded by Charles Dickens's public-domain status are therefore borrowed with humility and respect. Our use of his stylistic legacy is submitted entirely to the reader's judgment and shall be willingly withdrawn should this rendition be found unworthy of the spirit it seeks to honour.

"I have endeavoured in this Ghostly little book, to raise the Ghost of an Idea, which shall not put my readers out of humour with themselves, with each other, with the season, or with me. May it haunt their houses pleasantly, and no one wish to lay it."

— Adaptation from the original preface of Charles Dickens, *A Christmas Carol* (1843)

Christmas 2025

A Privacy Carol

An adaptation of Charles Dickens'

"A Christmas Carol"

*For there lies the deeper tragedy of prejudice:
Born not of malice, but of ignorance, conformity,
and the quiet inheritance of envy and bias.*

Chapter I

The Merciless Vetter

Marley was dead, to begin with. Dead as a doornail, there is no doubt whatever about that as, indeed, no company ledger would ever entertain the slightest uncertainty. Yet despite how thoroughly dead he remained, a new spectre now stalked the halls of office and commerce: the cold, unyielding heart of Ebenezer Scrooge, a hiring manager – and the most merciless vetter – of our present age.

Ah! But his miserliness was not of ledger and coin alone! Long had it curdled into a poverty of the spirit and a poverty of the soul, born of a suspicion that clung to every human being who crossed his path.

Therein, proud of his power to employ – upon which he would secretly nourish himself – Scrooge would sit alone each day in his narrow office, as a poorly backlit spectre, preying and gloating not upon his musty register, but still more on the pallid glow of a screen upon which he would perform his infamous, hollow, and petty “due diligence”: prying into private lives, weighing joys against metrics, and treating sincerity, probity, skill and trust as if they could be audited by the cold machinery of algorithms – Orwellian in design, tyrannical in intent.

“Aha!” he would cry. “How dare they display such a happiness that I alone am meant to bestow by the grace of my employment! And there, this other one – a young woman, radiant with joy, basking in the very love I have never known!”

Yet, as for the many other solemn souls – starch-collared, tight-buttoned, and so utterly drained of vitality that it seemed fear and regret had led them to banish all youth from their mortal frames – Scrooge would, indeed, find his utter and grim consolation: “What a marvellous and most appropriate posture!” he would mutter, drunken and fanciful in his towering vanity, believing that such portraits of grey deference had been purposely kindled by the mere summons to his presence, driven by a fervent, almost desperate passion for the grand, life-altering prospect that only his patronage could bestow upon them.

He was, however – as so many of us are – stark blind to the tragic truth: that such phantom joy and shivering subservience were never meant for him, but solely as a desperate pageant, staged for the fleeting promise of service and humble income, marshalled as a shield against the fear of disapproval and discrimination, and born of the quiet, agonizing hope to rise and escape the howling depths of hunger, bigotry, and despair.

But let it be forewarned that, however cruel such judgments might be, they were not entirely born of malice or vanity, as might be suspected. At their root and spring stood, indeed, a far deeper original sin: that of an uncharitable envy of those simple joys that he had long since cast from a life entirely his own.

Verily, he would turn his eye to a young bride’s wedding photographs and henceforth pronounce her utterly lacking in seriousness; or to a father’s modest holiday travels and decry his supposed want of dedication; or even to law graduates, caught in their university years, rejoicing over their most innocent indulgences.

“Hmph!” he would mutter. “The most miserable portrait! Are those supposed to be skills worth showcasing? And expecting me to pay for such nonsense?”

“Dear Lord! Wearing a mop-head as though it were the ceremonial wig? Order! Order! And what’s this – a toilet-brush sceptre? The laurels

of leadership, apparently! Outrageous! All of them – the most notorious liabilities to all my pencil-timed endeavours and success.”

“And that one, over there — I do declare!” he cried, his face twisting in pure disgust. “Is that not underwear perched atop his very head, as though he were crowning himself? Grr! Has he no sense at all, that the yellow is to point to the front, and the brown to the back? No! No! No! No employment for such nonsense!”

“Of a certainty, if summoned to witness all this parade of irreverence, the poor Bob Cratchit himself would not faint without first lashing out the most superb and unheard unchristian word!”

(...)

Thank you for your time and interest!

Carlos C. Ramirez

10 AUGUST 2026

The Carmesine-recast project

<https://github.com/Carmesine-project/The-Carmesine-recast-project>

email: carmesine-project@hotmail.com